r/realtors · 7mo ago
Icy-Profession6623

Should I get back into Real Estate?

Advice/Question

Hello everyone. I need some desperate career advice from anyone reading this.

I am 25 years old with no college degree. I went to a college preparatory school where majority of people went off to college to be lawyers or doctors. I went into real estate to be an agent. I hated the idea of college. I didn't want a boss and enjoyed freedom. This however completely backfired on me. For 4 years I lived with my mom, had no motivation to be great, nor had any confidence to help people with the biggest buying decisions of their lives. I made very very little money being a realtor. I found myself with a girlfriend then soon after we had a son. I DoorDashed 7-8 hours a day to make ends meet when she was pregnant. By the end of last year I decided to drop my realtor license, as it was costing more to keep being one than I was actually making. I got my insurance licenses and now work for a State Farm agent fully time for $30k plus a shitty commission structure. My girlfriend makes double what I make and works remotely from her phone really. I miss being with them when I'm away at work. I feel like I have matured greatly over the last year and a half, as I have a lot more responsibilities being a father. I have 100x more experience talking to people from cold calling in insurance. I am starting to miss real estate however. If I were to get back into it, I would probably get a waiter job somewhere close, and do open houses/cold calling when I'm not working shifts. I have never waited tables either. But I need some sort of steady paycheck before trying real estate again full time. Everyone I know already knows I quit real estate to get into insurance, and now it's going to look stupid if I get back into real estate. Not that I truly care what people think, I know people in their 20s sometimes have a million jobs and careers before they figure it out. If anyone took the time to read all of this, thank you in advance and God bless you.

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AutoModerator App MOD · 7mo ago

PropertyMatchmakerQ · 7mo ago · Realtor
I used to be that person. I call it "figuring it out". Some of us can do this well into our forties. You try it out. If it's not a good fit, change. When you test something out and decide it's not a good fit, that's not failure, it's information. Each move teaches you what energizes you, what drains you, and what aligns with your bigger goals. The key is making sure those changes are intentional instead of reactive.
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> **Icy-Profession6623** OP · 7mo ago
> Thank you for this1
> 3 · Award · Share

bradinphx · 7mo ago
Keep day job, get license back. Do open houses on the weekend.
7 · Award · Share

> **Objective-Mood-6467** · 7mo ago
> Like your advice there and if I were you I'd consider reading this small book called "The Dip"
>
> I don't think it's your career choice that's preventing your success
> 2 · Award · Share

DHumphreys · 7mo ago · Realtor · Top 1% Commenter
And why are you going to do open houses and cold calling?
3 · Award · Share

> **Budget-Piano-5199** · 7mo ago
> The OHs are statistically an enormous waste of time.
>
> However, the cold calling is not. Plus, he's already got those skills. Plus, he's 20-something and no one in his friend group is buying or selling anything of value except for weed so it's not like he's going to network his way to millions.
>
> OP, you bust ass cold calling, you'll do 15-20 deals your first year, easy. 3-4hrs every morning and you'll be an all star. By the time you're half the age of all these crusty agents on Reddit still hoping and hauling buyers all over town on a Sunday afternoon, you'll have enough referral and repeat business that you can put it on autopilot and essentially retire.
>
> Approximately 10% of your database should refer or repeat in any given year. Get to 500 deals and that's 50/year and all you have to do is not get hit by a bus and it just keeps coming.
>
> So, it's just a matter of how quickly you can get there. I'd advise to stop wasting time and pick up the phone.
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>> **DHumphreys** · 7mo ago · Realtor · Top 1% Commenter
>> I am not a fan of cold calling and with all the tech announcing that the call is spam, I suspect the cold calling angle is going to be low conversion.
>> 1 · Award · Share

>>> **Budget-Piano-5199** · 7mo ago
>>> Buddy, cold calling is by far the fastest, easiest, cheapest way to beau coup leads and thus beau coup deals that you can get.
>>>
>>> Who cares about conversion rates when you're *easily* talking to 25-50 active sellers per week?
>>>
>>> Real estate isn't a conversion equation, it's a conversation equation and y'all ain't talking to enough people. In fact, it's *impossible* for OP to talk to enough people to do any amount of significant business without using the telephone. Completely impossible.
>>>
>>> You'd have pay Zillow thousands upon thousands of dollars to get that many 'leads' on the phone and that's like, what, multiple months worth of these so-called leads?. But, hey, conversion rate is a whopping 10% and they half ass were aware someone might call, so there's that.
>>>
>>> And I might convert 100% of the people I meet be-bopping around town but, hot damn, how much be-bopping and networking I gotta do to get a deal? And how long does that take?
>>>
>>> Cold calling ain't for you, you think it's terrible, unwanted and you wouldn't list with someone who cold called you, fine, but OP has the skills (or at least the background) to crush it slinging real estate over the phone. Let the man eat.
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>>>> **DHumphreys** · 7mo ago · Realtor · Top 1% Commenter
>>>> And you are wrong that it is completely impossible.
>>>>
>>>> The beauty of this business is that there are a lot of ways to do it. If OP wants to grind it out on cold calling, I do not care.
>>>>
>>>> Bless your heart, have a nice day.
>>>> 1 · Award · Share

[deleted] · 7mo ago

Dry-Ad7961 · 7mo ago
In this job market stick to more stable careers. 25 is still young, you have a family so stability is important. Ask yourself what kind of life do you want? Do you want a remote job or on site? I didn't take none of those things into consideration when picking a career so now I'm back in school. Get recession proof jobs. Nurse, accountant (cpa), etc. You can become an RN easily via community college and continue schooling with working and become a telehealth nurse practitioner. Or get a bachelors in accounting and take the cpa exam. It's really up to you. But think about the lifestyle you want. Please keep in mind you're still young. 25 is very young. You can still move forward in life. Good luck!
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sunny_suburbia · 7mo ago
If you can see yourself enjoying the challenge and the details, do it. You have awesome drive and I love that you're putting your family first.
1 · Award · Share

Jackbv6 · 7mo ago
You stated you miss your family. If you're building a business from the bottom again, you may not have time for them. Real estate requires making a schedule to prospect for business and sticking to it. When you get the business, you can't stop prospecting. Double work. Are you committed? If you miss it, try it again. Bootstrap your expenses with door dashing until you get commissions coming in if the money makes sense.
1 · Award · Share

[deleted] · 7mo ago
I'd do anything to go back to when I started out. About your age. And then NEVER have anything to do with this business whatsoever!!!
1 · Award · Share

xoxottv187 · 7mo ago
I've had over 10+ jobs by 25 and about to get into real estate some of those jobs had potential but my mental maturity wasn't there for them as well as experience. I think having that insurance cold calling wil greatly benefit you. As well as having experience working with customers. As for looking stupid who cares could look stupid. It wouldn't look stupid if you making 60k in the first year would it? Give it another go id say sounds like you had a lot going on at the time starting out in real estate.
1 · Award · Share

happywithalist · 7mo ago
How cool of you to keep trying different things and giving yourself another chance to redeem yourself! Never give up on yourself!
1 · Award · Share

qweenoftherant · 7mo ago
If your heart is into it, I think you should get back into it!
1 · Award · Share

JamedSonnyCrocket · 7mo ago
Try to level up within insurance, get credentials and network. Build your sales skills and if you don't like insurance after another year, start selling something else. I'd avoid real estate
1 · Award · Share

[deleted] · 7mo ago
Didn't they recently change the commission structure for real estate agents that reduced it to flat rate?
1 · Award · Share

Lucky_Judge_3437 · 7mo ago
🧭 1-Year Comeback Plan: From Paycheck to Purpose 🎯 Goal: By the end of 12 months, you'll have: A steady income stream (no more paycheck anxiety) A revived real estate career that you control Family time built into your schedule A brand and story that earns trust and leads naturally Phase 1: Reset & Rebuild (Months 1–3) Focus: Get stable income + relicense in real estate + rebuild momentum ✅ Steps: Get a flexible serving or bartending job. Target $600–$800/week take-home. Focus on places with steady traffic and good tips (mid-level dining, not fine dining yet). Reinstate your real estate license. Choose a brokerage that allows part-time work and provides leads/open houses. Negotiate a low-fee, high-support split to minimize out-of-pocket costs. Rebuild your routine: Mornings (before work): 1 hour of learning or prospecting (YouTube, Tom Ferry, or Jason Walter real estate channels). Evenings: quality time with your girlfriend and son — non-negotiable. Start documenting your story on social media (even just once a week). Be honest, not salesy. Example: "I took a break from real estate to support my family. I'm back, hungrier and more experienced than ever." Mindset shift: Stability now → freedom later. You're not "starting over," you're rebuilding smarter. Phase 2: Build Pipeline & Presence (Months 4–6) Focus: Generate leads, build brand, close your first few deals again. ✅ Steps: Do open houses every weekend. Even if they're not your listings — ask other agents for opportunities. Use them to network, collect contacts, and record short videos. Leverage your insurance experience. Start conversations with renters, homeowners, or past leads — "By the way, if you ever want to explore buying instead of renting, I can walk you through options." Post 2–3 short-form videos per week. Mix personal story, home tips, and local spots ("Why I love [your city]"). Track contacts daily: Use a spreadsheet or free CRM (HubSpot or Notion). 💰 Money goals: Keep side job income steady (~$2.5–3k/month). Aim for 1 real estate deal by month 6. Even a $5–7k commission = proof of concept and confidence boost. Phase 3: Scale & Simplify (Months 7–9) Focus: Transition from side job to balanced real estate income. ✅ Steps: Reduce serving shifts by 1–2 days per week. Double down on open houses + referrals. Create a "Why I Came Back" post/video. Be raw and real — people respect authenticity and comeback stories. Follow up on every lead. 90% of agents don't — this is your edge. 💰 Money goals: 2–3 closed deals = $15–20k total commissions. Begin saving 3–4 months of expenses. Invest $200/month in brand (business cards, small ad spend, Canva pro, etc.). Phase 4: Breakthrough Year (Months 10–12) Focus: Go all-in on personal brand and consistent income. ✅ Steps: Replace serving job completely if income is sustainable. Join a networking group or local chamber (referrals start rolling). Build a simple website or Linktree with your listings and story. Launch a "1st-Time Buyer Series" (YouTube Shorts, Reels, TikTok). Keep it conversational, like you're talking to a friend, not selling. Keep learning: negotiation, market data, leadership, and mindset content. 💰 Money goals: Hit 5+ closings in the year. Gross income goal: $45–60k first year back. Enter 2026 with full-time real estate confidence. 🔑 Core Principles Family first. They're your "why." Use that fuel. Small wins daily > massive leaps occasionally. Document, don't overthink. Your story builds trust. Stay in motion. Momentum solves 90% of problems. Be proud of the bounce-back. Comeback stories inspire others — that's your brand. ✍️ Optional Daily Schedule (Sample) Time Task 7:00–8:00 AM Coffee, mindset reading, light exercise 8:00–9:00 AM Prospect calls / texts 9:00–3:00 PM Side job or family time (depending on shift) 4:00–6:00 PM Real estate tasks (open house prep, client follow-ups) 6:00–8:00 PM Dinner / family time 8:30–9:30 PM Watch training videos, post content, review progress 🔥 Final Words: You're not restarting — you're rebuilding as a man with purpose, perspective, and people who depend on you. That's strength, not shame. Stick to this plan for 12 months and I promise you'll look back next year and barely recognize the guy who wrote that message — because you'll be living the life that version of you was dreaming about.
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browngirlindxb · 7mo ago
DM me. I'm a recruiter. And I am looking for agents
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> **AutoModerator** App MOD · 7mo ago
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>
> *I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit] if you have any questions or concerns.*
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>> **[deleted]** · 7mo ago
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